

1830–1838

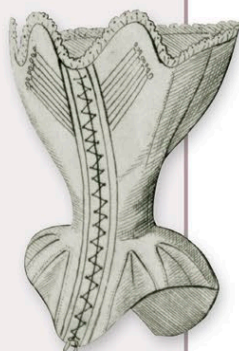
TURBANS AND TIGHT LACING

Evening wear at the start of the 1830s had boat necklines that emphasized the champagne-bottle necks that were so admired. Turbans, an Oriental fashion formed of long scarves imported from India, fed the desire for exotic fabrics and an air of mystique gleaned from Romantic and Gothic novels. The turban became a favoured style of older ladies for going out to dinner, opera, and parties. These ladies, who had sported bare arms in the neoclassical era, now benefited from transparent oversleeves for evening. From 1835 the neckline drew in, and the sleeve head was pulled down with pleating, which restricted movement. Bodices dipped down slightly at the front and hemlines returned to floor length. Crin (horsehair) was now used extensively in linen petticoats to stiffen them.

STRAPLESS CORSET



Boned corsets cut with triangular gores (panels) under the arm and on the hips created the desired hourglass figure. A centre front steel busk and corded panels forced an erect form. Metal eyelets allowed for tighter lacing for a more fitted shape and dispensed with shoulder straps, to suit the wide boat necklines.



Diagonally laced corset

Ball dress Appliqué bows in zigzag vandyke pattern circle the skirt of this dress. Young ladies in the marriage market were encouraged to adopt each new novelty in fashion, be it the direction of a bow or the exact tilt of a haircomb.



Boat neckline

1830



Ornate headdress

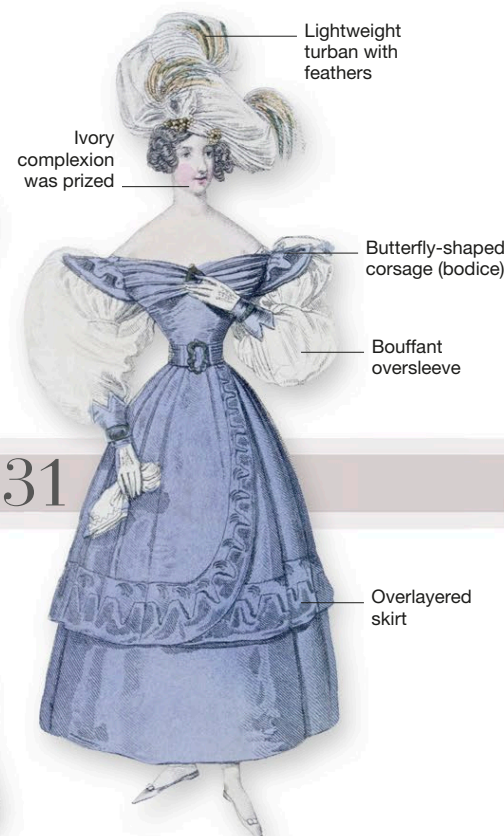
Bunch of silver wheat

Necklace of hanging pearls, *en girandole*

Lappets of blond lace

Feathered headdress This woman's ornate headdress includes a plume of three ostrich feathers, a gold comb decorated with pearls, and a pearl bandeau that goes around her forehead. Her dress is trimmed with blond lace and a satin rouleau.

1831



Lightweight turban with feathers

Ivory complexion was prized

Butterfly-shaped corsage (bodice)

Bouffant oversleeve

Overlayered skirt

Bouffant gown Large bouffant oversleeves and a butterfly-shaped corsage, or bodice, emphasize the impossibly narrow waist of this purple silk evening gown and create an ethereal effect. The expansive turban is worn at an angle.